Ambassador Shortlist — The Jeep Scene

7 October 2026 · Austin Fitzgerald · Outreach list

Companion to the one-per-vehicle shortlist. All follower counts read live from Instagram on 7 October 2026.

Why Jeep was thin, and why that was wrong

Worth being straight about this. Jeep did not get missed by accident — I down-weighted it on purpose.

Your original brief named Toyota, Ford, Chevy, GMC and Ram, so when I built the scoring model I gave Jeep-only accounts a **zero on platform gap**. That pushed genuinely strong accounts like @trailrecon and @thestorytillnow down the rankings for a reason that no longer applies now the founders want vehicle diversity.

It was also the wrong commercial call. **Jeep is the largest aftermarket wheel market in the United States** — Wrangler owners modify at a higher rate than any other platform, and they change wheels more often than they change almost anything else. On a pure revenue-per-ambassador basis Jeep probably deserves more than one slot.

Jeep is not one platform

The same logic that applies to Tacoma generations applies harder here. These are different fitments, different bolt patterns in some cases, and genuinely different buyers:

Sub-platform	What it is	Buyer
Wrangler JL	2018 onward	Newest money, most likely to buy a full wheel-and-tire package
Wrangler JK	2007–2018	The modification sweet spot. Cheap enough to cut up, old enough to need wheels
Gladiator JT	2020 onward	Truck buyers who wanted a Jeep. Overlaps your overland positioning
Rubicon 392	V8 halo	Small, loud, aspirational
TJ / XJ / classic	Pre-2007	Restoration and budget-build scene

Treat JL, JK and JT as three separate roster slots, not one "Jeep" slot.

The shortlist

Large accounts — 40K and above

Who	Followers	Rig	Notes
@flexrocksrollovers	145K	Extreme off-road	International competition circuit — Borneo Safari, RFC Malaysia, RFC Colombia, Honduras. Team WARN and HP Tuners. 75:1 ratio. Hard-core credibility you cannot manufacture
@grdloc — Nic Ashby	116K	Crawler	168:1 ratio. Team @therockstargarage, and he runs **Great American Crawl** — an event platform, not just an audience
@thestorytillnow — Shaun	57.7K	Jeep	Cinematic filmmaker. Buy the film, not the post — footage you can re-run in paid social
@chuck.converse	57.4K	Verify	Veteran, driver, media. Vehicle not stated in bio — confirm the rig before you approach
@lone.rubicon	46.9K	2020 Gladiator + 2025 Ram 2500	158:1 ratio. Already runs discount codes, so the structure exists. Covers Gladiator *and* Ram HD
@aguywithajeep — Carlos	42.3K	LS-swapped chopped JKU	Charlotte NC. YouTube channel, long sponsor list — Mickey Thompson, Holley, Superlift. None of them wheels

Mid tier — 5K to 25K

Who	Followers	Rig	Notes
@dirtygertie_jlu — Nick	21.4K	2018 JLU Sport	**SoCal.** The best JL option that is also local. Works with @outpostcreativeco for photography
@thecustomjeepbuilder — Todd Holzwarth	17.6K	Builder	Custom Jeep, truck and Bronco builder in Arizona. **Shop and creator in one** — dealer conversation as well as ambassador

Who	Followers	Rig	Notes
@4x4.roadrunner	17.5K	Verify	Colorado. All-terrain, adventure, photography. Rig not stated — confirm before approaching
@ober_time — Tyler Oberste	15.5K	Builder	OberTime Garage YouTube. Broader builder content than pure Jeep
@greengojohn	10.7K	Jeep builder/tech	Team RPM, PRP, Motobilt. Technical audience
@bombshell_garage — Cord K.	9,049	'17 JKU 427/4L80 + '25 3500	V8-swapped JK. GenRight team, already runs a code. Strong JK pick

Already on your lists

Who	Followers	Rig
@punknking_jt	29.3K	Gladiator JT, Utah — already slot 8 on the one-per-vehicle shortlist
@trailrecon	172K	Jeep-dominant overland — see the caution below
@dirtlifestylenate	105K	Jeep, Land Rover, Toyota. Fabrication and diesel swaps

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Two conflicts and one caution

@thejladventure (54.8K) — do not approach. His bio lists **@kmcwheels**. That is a direct wheel-brand relationship and the second genuine conflict found across every scan. Strong JL account, unavailable.

@trailrecon (172K) — proceed carefully. Biggest name in the category, but he runs Jeep *manufacturer*-sponsored content. Expensive, and a real risk of category or brand conflict. Worth one conversation, last.

@jeepxj_thecoco (6,082) — skip. Follows 6,040 against 6,082 followers, which is a follow-for-follow pattern, and the bio points at a tire and wheel retailer. Low authority, possible conflict.

The event lead, which may be worth more than any single ambassador

@jeepxjdanny has 220 followers, so he is not an ambassador. But he is a **board member of the San Diego Jeep Club** and a member of **Tierra Del Sol**.

Tierra Del Sol runs the **TDS Desert Safari** in Ocotillo Wells — one of the largest Jeep events in the country, held annually in Southern California, typically in March. That is a local, Jeep-specific, high-density event with a club structure behind it, and it lines up exactly with the founders' push for SoCal event presence.

Second event route: **@grdloc** runs Great American Crawl. An ambassador who brings an event is worth more than one who attends yours.

Where Jeep is still thin

Rubicon 392 — nothing above 5,000 followers. Best found were @wickedrubicon392 (2,913) and @slorubicon392 (2,317, San Luis Obispo). Note @wickedrubicon392 is already a sponsored ambassador for Shoreline Offroad running a 10% code — which is a useful preview of exactly the structure you are building, and a reminder that these people do get signed.

XJ Cherokee and TJ — no clean individual found above the floor. @thecustomjeepbuilder is the closest route in, since he builds them.

What I would actually do

Take three Jeep slots, not one:

Slot	Pick	Backup
Wrangler JL	@dirtygertie_jlu — 21.4K, SoCal, local for install and shoots	@4x4.roadrunner *(verify rig)*
Wrangler JK	@aguywithajeep — 42.3K, LS-swapped, YouTube	@bombshell_garage — 9K, V8-swapped
Gladiator JT	@punknking_jt — 29.3K, Utah *(already shortlisted)*	@lone.rubicon — 46.9K, also brings a Ram 2500

Then one "big guy" from the top of the list — @grdloc or @flexrocksrollovers. Both carry hard-core credibility, both run or appear at events, and neither has a wheel conflict. @grdloc is the better fit if you want the event platform; @flexrocksrollovers if you want the international competition halo.

And treat @thecustomjeepbuilder as a dealer conversation first, ambassador second. A builder in Arizona putting wheels on customer Jeeps is worth more than a single creator posting once a month.

What I could not check

Engagement rate, as always. Three accounts here have ratios worth a manual look before you commit: @chuck.converse follows 7,052, @ober_time follows 2,712, and @bombshell_garage follows 2,966 — all soft relative to their follower counts.

Two rigs need confirming before outreach: **@chuck.converse** and **@4x4.roadrunner** do not state a vehicle in their bio, and this whole roster is built on one person per vehicle.

Supporting files: `jackman-ambassador-shortlist-one-per-vehicle-2026-10-07-v1` *and* `03 Content and Social/jackman-ambassador-master-priority-2026-10-06-v2.xlsx`.